

1 Analytic Introduction to Logic

If you are reading this text, it is because you are taking a course on *logic*. Most of us understand intuitively that logic has something to do with thinking correctly, but, because one of the goals of this course is to improve our capacity for precision and thoroughness in forming our concepts, we will not be satisfied with a vague and poorly defined intuition. The question that should immediately arise, therefore, is “What precisely is logic?” This introduction will attempt to give a precise and rigorous answer to that question; for that reason, it will need to introduce certain ideas from epistemology, metaphysics, philosophical anthropology. Although these are not actually part of subject matter of logic—the *material object*, as we shall learn to call it—they are nevertheless indispensable for learning what logic actually *is*. Introducing these topics will also help serve one of the reasons why logic is taught at the beginning of philosophical studies at all: namely, to lay the groundwork for the study of metaphysics.

[Make summary of outline here]